CHAPTER

2

NATURAL FIBRES

U5MRFJ

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To learn about the natural fibres.
- To gain knowledge in the manufacturing process of cotton, silk, wool.
- To understand the characteristics of common natural fibres.

2.1 INTRODUCTION

Natural fibres are taken from the plant and animal sources. Since they are available naturally in the plant, animal or minerals, they are called as natural fibres. Cotton, silk and wool are the most well known natural fibres. There are several other commonly used natural fibres like jute, flax, linen and asbestos.

Plant Fibres

Seed Fibre

The fibres that are collected from various plant seeds are known as seed fibres. Example: Cotton (Figure 2.1).

Leaf Fibre

The fibres that are taken or collected from leaves are known as leaf fibre. Example: Pineapple and banana (Figure 2.2).

DO YOU KNOW?

Which is the oldest natural fiber?


Flax Fibers

Flax is the earliest known natural textile fabric seen used in about 5000 BC. Flax is the material used to make linen which is seeing a huge come back today in drapery and upholstery.



Figure 2.1 Seed Fibre – Cotton

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